

Usama Jamal

Contact Information

THEMA, Department of Economics,
CY Cergy Paris University,
33 Bd du Port, 95000 Cergy, France

usama-jamal.github.io
usama.jamal.econ@gmail.com
Phone: +33 744 820 981

Academic Position

2025 - Present Postdoctoral Research Fellow, THEMA, CY Cergy Paris University

Prior Education

2020 - 2025 Ph.D. in Economics, University of Manchester
2024 Visiting Ph.D. Student, Centre for Business Taxation, University of Oxford
2023 Ph.D. Internship, International Monetary Fund (IMF)

Research Fields

Primary Field: Public Economics
Secondary Fields: Applied Microeconomics, Corporate Finance, Development Economics

Job Market Paper

Tax Rules and Capital Reallocation: Real Effects of Anti-Tax Avoidance Policies

Under Review

Best Paper Award, RIEF Doctoral Meeting 2026

Abstract: Anti-tax avoidance policies aim to curb profit shifting by MNEs, yet their effects on capital costs and economic growth remain a critical question. This study examines the causal impacts of the Earnings Stripping Rule (ESR)—a core anti-tax-avoidance measure adopted by more than ninety countries in the last decade—that limits profit shifting through debt channels but increases the cost of debt-financed capital. Using a large panel dataset on global MNE operations and a staggered difference-in-difference design, I compare the real activities of MNEs affected by ESR with those of unaffected groups. I find that ESR effectively reduces profit shifting and tax avoidance but also lowers investments in affected subsidiaries. MNEs offset these declines by reallocating capital and employment toward unconstrained affiliates, primarily abroad. However, as the policy coverage expands across a group's global footprint, this reallocation shifts from foreign to domestic units, closing the international escape margin and raising group-level tax liabilities. These findings suggest that international coordination is crucial for designing effective, non-distortionary anti-avoidance policies.

Other Working Papers

Harder to Evade, Easier to Distort: The Welfare Costs of Anti-Avoidance Rules

Under Review

(with Muhammad Bashir, Kyle McNabb, & Mazhar Waseem)

Size-Based Policies and Firm Growth: Evidence from Pakistan

(with Muhammad Bashir, Zehra Farooq, & Mazhar Waseem)

GCC Growth and Diversification: The Role of Cross-Border Investment and Sovereign Wealth Funds

(with Yevgeniya Korniyenko & Weining Xin)

Work-in-Progress

Taxing Innovation Income: R&D and Windfalls under France's IP Box Reform

(with Sébastien Laffitte)

The Worker Incidence of Anti-Tax-Avoidance Policy: Evidence from France

(with Marylou Colombet)

Preferential Tax Regimes and Firms' Outcomes: Evidence from Panama's SEM Regime

(with Pierre Bachas & Sébastien Laffitte)

Disparities in Air Pollution Exposure in India: Any Policy to Blame?

(with Ujjayant Chakravorty, Ron Chan, & Martino Pelli)

Honours & Awards

2026	Best Paper Award , RIEF Doctoral Meeting
2020 - 2024	Ph.D. Fellowship, University of Manchester

Research Grants

2024	International Growth Centre funding for the project "Illicit Financial Flows from the Global South: Evidence from Uganda", (joint with Muhammad Bashir, Kyle McNabb, & Mazhar Waseem) April 2024 - March 2026, £29,950
2024	International Centre for Tax & Development grant for the project "Illicit Financial Flows from the Global South: Evidence from Uganda", (joint with Muhammad Bashir, Kyle McNabb, & Mazhar Waseem) February 2024 - June 2025, £20,375
2023	World Bank grant for the project "Spur Winning FDI: The Role of Sovereign Wealth Funds in GCC Economic Diversification", (joint with Yevgeniya Korniyenko & Weining Xin) November 2023 - June 2024, \$7,000
2022	UNU-WIDER grant for the project "Illicit Financial Flows from the Global South: Evidence from Uganda", (joint with Muhammad Bashir, Kyle McNabb, & Mazhar Waseem) October 2022 - September 2023, \$10,000

Conferences & Seminars

2026	RIEF Doctoral Meeting, Université Paris-Saclay (Best Paper Award); 3rd PhD Conference in Economics, University of Rome Tor Vergata; NTA Annual Conference on Taxation; Beyond BEPS: Real Effects of International Taxation Workshop, Charles University
2025	NBER Conference on The Economic Analysis of Business Taxation ; Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD); European Association of Young Economists Annual Conference; Irish Public Economics Workshop; Paris School of Economics; Georgetown University Qatar; Aix-Marseille University; Bilkent University; American University in Cairo (AUC); American University of Sharjah (AUS); Lahore University of Management Sciences (LUMS); Xiamen University; Habib University
2024	Macquarie University; PSE-CEPR Public Economics Forum; Royal Economic Society Annual Conference; ZEW Annual Public Finance Conference; Centre for Business Taxation, University of Oxford; SANEM Annual Economist Conference; Association for Mentoring and Inclusion in Economics; Annual ASPEC Conference, Oxford Brookes University
2023	International Monetary Fund; United Nations University - World Institute for Development Economics Research; North West Social Science Doctoral Training Partnership

Research & Teaching Experience

Teaching Associate

2024 - 2025 Macroeconomics 1; Macroeconomics 2; Microeconomics 1; Econometrics; International Trade & Policy; Energy Economics and Policy (University of Manchester)

Research Assistant

2022 (full year) **Ron Chan**
Winter 2019 **Global Development Institute**
Summer 2017 **Mazhar Waseem**

Teaching Assistant

Spring 2021 Microeconomics II (University of Manchester)
2017 - 2019 Microeconomics I; Microeconomics II; Probability; Statistics (Lahore University of Management Sciences)

Tutor, appointed by the Dean

2018 - 2019 Microeconomics; Econometrics (Lahore University of Management Sciences)

Administrative Experience

2022 - 2023 ORBIS Database Administrator, University of Manchester
2021 Learning Design Coordinator for Econometrics & Advanced Mathematics, University of Manchester

References

Mazhar Waseem

University of Manchester

mazhar.waseem@manchester.ac.uk

Sébastien Laffitte

CY Cergy Paris University

sebastien.laffitte@cyu.fr

Katarzyna Bilicka

Utah State University

katarzyna.anna.bilicka@gmail.com